

**DEPARTMENT OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION
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LECTURE NOTES

ON

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BY

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COMMUNICATION IN AN ORGANIZATION

The term 'Communication' is derived from the Latin word 'communis' which means common. Communication means to inform, tell, show, or spread information. It creates confidence among human beings and enhances good industrial relations. Communication is a two-way process involving the following elements: a **sender**, a **message**, a **medium**, a **channel**, a **receiver**, a **response**, and **feedback**.

Communication is a process through which information idea or opinion is transferred to a greater number of persons. If information is communicated to only one person, it will also be termed communication. But, the essential element of communication is that the communicated information should be understood correctly and transferred in the right direction. Communication is a process by which information is exchanged between individuals through a common system of symbols, signs, or behavior.

Communication Breakdown in an Organization

Communication breakdown is defined as a failure to exchange information, resulting in a lack of communication. The causes include the following:

- Hierarchical organization.
- Unopened line of communication with the management.
- Sending irrelevant information.
- Non-availability of platform for employees.
- Incorrect ways of communication.
- Stressful work environment. Etc

A hierarchical organization: an organization where structures are too vertical or complex makes information flow difficult, some information might get lost and others must get distorted. Sometimes, you have different offices in different geographical places, and that makes collaboration and communication even more complicated.

Unopened line of communication with the management: If your employees cannot communicate easily with management, then it is going to be difficult for management to keep track of what their employees are doing and what kind of progress they are making, and what they required. They need to communicate with each other efficiently to ask questions, address issues, or stay up to date. Lack of communication lines between employees and management will make the employees less productive and they might even feel less valued since there is no way for them to have their issues address

Sending irrelevant information: If managers are constantly sending messages to their employee irrelevant messages is a real problem, particularly if an urgent message gets ignored because the recipients assume that it might be irrelevant.

The non-availability of a platform for employees: companies should use a secure communication platform to communicate with their employees. If you do not have that, team members will find ways to communicate with each other, but this might lead to employees using modes of communication that may not be secure. For example, they may send emails to each other containing sensitive information situations that will put at risk sensitive data and will make it more difficult to track productivity. There are plenty of software solutions to communicate directly with your employees and share relevant information, such platforms promote and secure easy communication.

Incorrect ways of communication: different interactions require different modes of communication. The topic and urgency of the message will define the right way of communication. For example, if you have an urgent message for your employees, mailing out letters to their addresses is not the right way to address this issue. Calling them directly might be an effective way.

Stressful work environment: A stressful work environment can strain communication between employees in the workplace. An example of this is when employees are feeling overloaded, and the company does not have enough staff. A stressful work environment can make it hard for employees to communicate effectively. If they are overwhelmed with work, they may forget to send important messages to their managers or co-workers, and that will affect communication negatively. Also, if employees are afraid of sharing their views or if the work environment is too competitive, they may keep back information from co-workers that could help them do their job more effectively.

Communication Strategies in an Organization

Communication strategies vary from organization to organization to overcome communication barriers, the following methods may be followed by organizations:

1. **Employee orientation:** If employees are given orientation about organizational objectives, policies, procedures, programs, authority relations, etc., communication barriers stand minimized significantly. employees are required to be communicated about vision, mission, goals, objectives, and strategies, and if required, they need to be involved in developing the same. Such participation enhances commitment from employees and transparency makes them informed. Unfortunately, this aspect gets neglected in organizations, which culminates in conflict and creates organizational barriers. emulated.

2. **Improving interpersonal relations:** Improved interpersonal relations develop mutuality in organizations with employees becoming more cooperative and working together for accomplishing organizational goals. This requires superiors to respect the dignity and authority of their subordinates, which in turn develops the subordinates' trust in their superiors and eliminates status differences. Such an environment in an organization makes it possible for managers to communicate freely even through their contacts and make communication a truly two-way process.
3. **Empathetic listening:** Superiors often use their status and talk more in the course of discussions with subordinates, without allowing them to express their feelings and emotions. Lack of such listening quite obviously creates barriers to communication, as managers evaluate information without getting a free and frank response from subordinates.
4. **Using proper language:** Communication barriers are often created due to semantic distortions. This can be avoided by using direct and simple language in communication. Avoiding technical terms, words with more than one meaning, difficult symbols, etc. makes it possible to eliminate communication barriers.
5. **Communication through actions:** Actions speak louder than words. When subordinates communicate and superiors do not act upon them, it sends back a wrong message, which dissuades future communication. The same thing happens when the actions of superiors differ from what they say. This leads to a situation in which subordinates listen but do not act. Such barriers require to be eliminated through actions and deeds.
6. **Judicious use of grapevine:** A grapevine is important for communication. But at times when managers depend too much on the grapevine, ignoring official channels of communication, it develops a culture of informal communication and thereby creates barriers to communication. Hence, the grapevine needs to be judiciously used.

Problems of Communication in an Organization

- Use of jargon
- The opening
- Emotional barriers and taboos.
- Physical barriers to non-verbal communication.
- Expectations and prejudices.
- Cultural differences.
- Information overload. Etc

Use of jargon/ unfamiliar and/or technical terms: Most departments and companies have their jargon, used daily while creating a false feeling that everyone uses our "language." It gets an even deeper experience. When our field of experience overlaps only a little, communication becomes difficult.

The opening: In the opening, there's a golden rule about discussion and communication before we start, let us set up the ground, and avoid introducing abbreviations without definitions and references to any local, not well-known term. Specify the target of the meeting, and what you would like to speak about and agree on.

Emotional barriers and taboos: Some people may find it difficult to specify their emotions and a few topics could also be completely 'off-limits' or taboo. Taboo or difficult topics may include but are not limited to, politics, religion, disabilities (mental and physical), sexuality and sex, racism, and any opinion which will be seen as unpopular.

Physical barriers to non-verbal communication: not having the ability to determine the non-verbal cues, gestures, posture, and general visual communication can make communication less effective. Phone calls, text messages, and other communication methods that depend upon technology are often less effective than face-to-face communication.

Expectations and prejudice: Expectations and prejudice can cause false assumptions or stereotypes. People often hear what they expect to listen to instead of what is said, and they jump to incorrect conclusions.

Cultural differences: Cultural differences in norms of social interaction vary greatly in several cultures, as do the way emotions are expressed. As an example, the concept of private space varies between cultures and between different social settings.

Information overload: Additionally, to phone calls, video conferences, text messages, group chats, social networks, and internal meetings a typical person can receive as many as 110 emails a day. Email overload is bad for communication and often ends up in important information being lost, deleted, forgotten, or ignored. Employees are easily frustrated by an excessive amount of data

what is cross-cultural communication? Cross-cultural communication is the process of recognizing both differences and similarities among cultural groups to effectively engage within a given context. This type of communication provides understanding cultures speak, communicate and perceive the world around them.

what is persuasive communication? Persuading is the act of influencing others' decisions and actions by any means of communication. Understanding persuasive communication can help to anticipate the audience's response to decisions, proposals, and ideas.

Characteristics of Persuasive Communication

- ✓ Audience
- ✓ Comprehension
- ✓ Acceptance
- ✓ Retention

Audience: The center of all persuasive communication is the audience. **Attention:** One must first get the intended audience to listen to what one has to say.

Comprehension: The intended audience must understand the message presented.

Acceptance: The intended audience must accept the arguments or conclusions presented in the communication. This different culture Consequently, it fosters greater trust. When employees or customers are aware of potential differences and similarities, they're likely to pay closer attention. acceptance is based on the reward in the message

Retention: The message must be remembered.

Self-assessment Questions

1. How can poor communication be improved in the workplace?
2. What are persuasive communication and its importance
3. Explain cross-cultural communication and state the characteristics of convincing communication.
4. Write short notes on the following:
 - a) Information overload
 - b) Hierarchical organization
 - c) Expectations and prejudice
 - d) Cultural differences.